Unspool finance model

Profit by user count, 10k to 10M · usage tiers · October 2026 · assumptions, not forecasts

1. Tiers

Tier	Price	What you get
Free	$0	1 reel per document, then 1 every 30 min (max 5/day), generated only when opened
1-day trial	$0 then $7.99	Plus for 24 h (card required, max 30 reels, once per account)
Plus	$7.99/mo	150 reels/mo, no watermark
Pro	$14.99/mo	500 reels/mo, longer docs, priority
Ultra	$29.99/mo	2,000 reels/mo, priority
Top-up	$2.49 once	+20 reels, never expire

2. Assumptions (same at every size)

- **Mix:** 94% free, 4% Plus, 1.5% Pro, 0.5% Ultra (6% paying). 2% of users buy one top-up a month. Trial conversions are folded into the paid shares.
- **Usage:** 30% of free users active a month, ~3 reels each. Paid users use ~40% of quota (Plus 60, Pro 200, Ultra 600 reels).
- **AI cost:** $0.03 per reel (Claude Haiku script, OpenAI voice, ~5 FLUX images, render). Today's estimate is ~$0.035–0.04.
- **Stripe:** 2.9% + $0.30 per charge. **Infra** (hosting, database, video storage, bandwidth, email): $0.03 per registered user per month, minimum $500.
- **Not included:** salaries, marketing, support, refunds, chargebacks, income tax, VAT/sales tax. Real profit is lower.

3. Profit by user count (base case)

Registered users	Paying	Revenue / mo	Stripe / mo	AI / mo	Infra / mo	Profit / mo	Profit / yr
10,000	600	$7,442	$456	$2,894	$500	**$3,592**	**$43,109**
25,000	1,500	$18,605	$1,140	$7,235	$750	**$9,481**	**$113,771**
50,000	3,000	$37,210	$2,279	$14,469	$1,500	**$18,962**	**$227,543**
100,000	6,000	$74,420	$4,558	$28,938	$3,000	**$37,924**	**$455,086**
250,000	15,000	$186,050	$11,395	$72,345	$7,500	**$94,810**	**$1,137,715**
500,000	30,000	$372,100	$22,791	$144,690	$15,000	**$189,619**	**$2,275,429**
1,000,000	60,000	$744,200	$45,582	$289,380	$30,000	**$379,238**	**$4,550,858**
2,500,000	150,000	$1,860,500	$113,955	$723,450	$75,000	**$948,096**	**$11,377,146**
5,000,000	300,000	$3,721,000	$227,909	$1,446,900	$150,000	**$1,896,191**	**$22,754,292**
10,000,000	600,000	$7,442,000	$455,818	$2,893,800	$300,000	**$3,792,382**	**$45,508,584**

4. Yearly profit range

Low = half as many people pay (3%), High = 1.5× (9%). Everything else base.

Registered users	Low	Base	High
10,000	$18,756	$43,109	$67,462
25,000	$52,889	$113,771	$174,654
50,000	$105,778	$227,543	$349,308
100,000	$211,556	$455,086	$698,615
250,000	$528,891	$1,137,715	$1,746,538
500,000	$1,057,782	$2,275,429	$3,493,076
1,000,000	$2,115,564	$4,550,858	$6,986,153
2,500,000	$5,288,910	$11,377,146	$17,465,382
5,000,000	$10,577,820	$22,754,292	$34,930,764
10,000,000	$21,155,640	$45,508,584	$69,861,528

5. Detail at 10M users

Tier	Price	Share	Users	Revenue / mo	Reels / mo
Free	$0	94.0%	9,400,000	$0	8,460,000
Plus	$7.99	4.0%	400,000	$3,196,000	24,000,000
Pro	$14.99	1.5%	150,000	$2,248,500	30,000,000
Ultra	$29.99	0.5%	50,000	$1,499,500	30,000,000
Top-up	$2.49 once	2% buy 1/mo	200,000	$498,000	4,000,000

Totals at 10M: revenue $7,442,000/mo, 96,460,000 reels/mo, profit $3,792,382/mo ($45,508,584/yr).

6. Reading this

- Profit scales almost linearly because most costs are per reel. At small sizes the fixed $500 infra floor matters a little; staff and marketing (not shown) matter a lot.
- Free users are now cheap (1 reel up front, the rest only when opened), so growth no longer drains money.
- The biggest lever is the share of users who pay. Each extra 1% of users on Plus adds about $565,829 profit a month at 10M users ($5,658 at 100k).

Planning only. Replace every rate with real conversion, usage and cost data after launch.